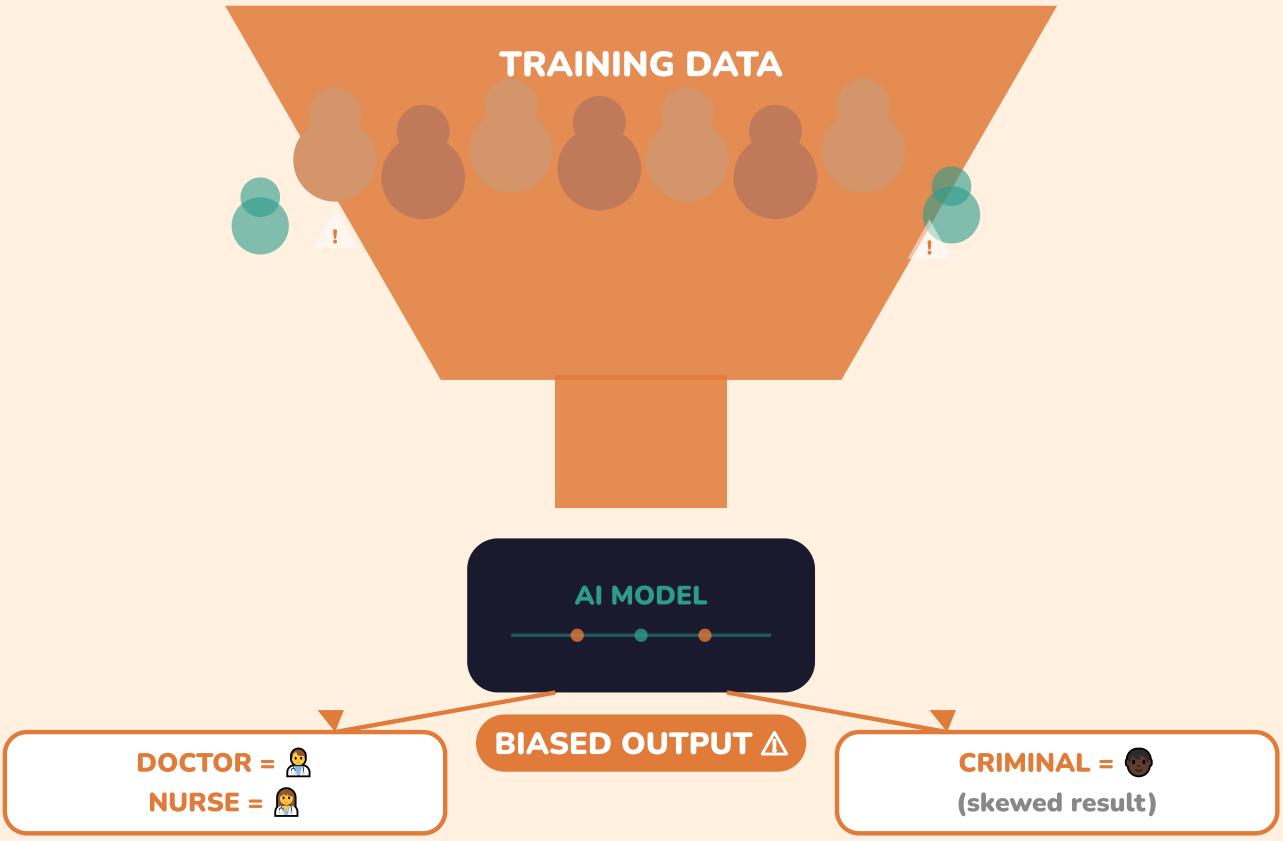
WHERE DOES AI BIAS COME FROM?

If AI learns from people, does it also learn our mistakes?



SORT

SPOT

CHALLENGE

WHERE DOES AI BIAS COME FROM?

Bias is not a bug — it is a feature of how these systems work. Students often think bias means "broken." This card helps them see it as a structural outcome of choices made during data collection, labelling, and design.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Show an image search result (real or simulated): search "CEO" and count gender/race representation. Same for "nurse," "criminal," "scientist." Record results on the board.
2. Discuss: where do these results come from? What data was used? Who chose it? Was anyone trying to cause bias?
3. Students "build" a simple dataset in groups: select 20 images for training an AI to recognise "a good student." What do they include? What gets left out?
4. Swap datasets with another group and critique: whose vision of "good student" is this?

MATERIALS

- Printed image search result sheets
- Blank dataset-building worksheets
- Selection criteria discussion cards
- Swap envelopes for group exchange
- Critique template for peer review

REFLECTION

- Can a dataset ever be fully neutral?
- Who decides what gets included in training data?
- What happens when a biased AI makes real decisions?
- Can we fix bias after training?

REALITY CHECK

AI reflects the data it was trained on.

If that data is unrepresentative, incomplete, or historically biased, the AI will reproduce and sometimes amplify those biases. The problem starts long before the algorithm — in who collected the data, and how.

DIGITAL GAME

Dataset Builder

Scan to play →